Code of Conduct

Fictional sample document for this PoC; not a real policy.

1. Purpose and respectful behaviour

The company expects employees to act honestly, respectfully, and responsibly in their work. This fictional code applies in the office, during business travel, at company events, and in work-related online communication. The Head of People owns the code and oversees its annual review. Managers are expected to explain standards, respond to concerns, and model the behaviour they ask of others. Seniority does not exempt a person from these expectations.

Employees must not engage in bullying, harassment, threats, or discriminatory treatment. Disagreement about work should focus on evidence and decisions rather than personal attacks. A colleague may raise a concern even if the conduct was directed at someone else. Managers should make room for different communication needs and ensure that remote colleagues can participate in team discussions. Conduct expectations apply equally to messages sent from home and conversations held at company premises.

2. Integrity and external relationships

2.1 Gifts and hospitality

Employees must declare any gift or hospitality worth more than SGD 50 to the Compliance Lead within 5 working days of receiving the offer. Gifts of cash or cash equivalents are prohibited regardless of value.

An employee must not accept an offered gift while making a purchasing decision involving the giver. The declaration records the giver, estimated value, date, and business relationship; the Compliance Lead decides whether the item may be accepted, returned, or shared with the company. Several gifts from the same source should be assessed together rather than split to avoid the declaration rule. Declining an inappropriate gift courteously is preferable to accepting it and seeking retrospective approval.

2.2 Conflicts of interest

Disclose an actual or potential conflict of interest to the Compliance Lead before taking part in the affected decision. A conflict includes a close personal relationship with a supplier, outside work that competes with company duties, or a financial interest that could influence a purchasing decision.

The Compliance Lead records an agreed management plan, which may require stepping back from a selection panel or changing approval responsibilities. Disclosure does not automatically prohibit an outside activity; it allows the company to assess the situation openly. Update the disclosure within five working days if the circumstances change. An employee should not decide alone that a relationship is too minor to disclose when a reasonable colleague could question their impartiality.

3. Speaking up

3.1 Reporting concerns

Employees may report suspected misconduct to their line manager, People Operations, or the Compliance Lead. People Operations acknowledges a report within 2 working days and assigns a case owner who is independent of the concern where practical.

A report should describe what happened, approximate dates, and any existing evidence, but an employee does not need to conduct an investigation before reporting. If the line manager is involved, use one of the other reporting routes. A case owner explains the next steps and provides a progress update at least every 10 working days while the matter remains open. Personal information is shared only with people who need it to assess and respond to the concern.

3.2 Protection against retaliation

Retaliation against a person who raises a concern in good faith or assists an investigation is prohibited. Report suspected retaliation directly to the Head of People, who arranges an independent review.

Good faith means that the employee honestly believes the information may be relevant, even if an investigation does not substantiate the concern. Deliberately inventing an allegation is different from making an honest mistake. Managers must not remove normal work opportunities or pressure a person to withdraw a report because it is inconvenient. Employees should preserve relevant records and avoid discussing confidential case details with uninvolved colleagues.

4. Company resources and records

Employees use company funds, equipment, and information for authorised purposes. Expense claims must describe the actual purchase and business purpose, with the approvals required by the Travel and Expenses Policy. Submitting the same receipt twice, inventing an attendee, or changing the amount on a receipt is prohibited. An honest error should be reported to Finance promptly so it can be corrected with a clear record of the change.

Company devices and access credentials must be protected as described in the Information Security Policy. A remote workspace does not relax confidentiality expectations, and a personal relationship does not authorise sharing customer information. Employees must not delete or alter records requested for an investigation. Managers who receive a concern involving an immediate information-security risk should also contact Information Security so protective action can begin without waiting for the conduct review to conclude.